

Put It in Writing

Whatever your goal, simply dreaming about it won't make it happen. A goal should be written down and reviewed often. Written goals give you something to work toward and make your efforts to save more meaningful.

Figuring out how to achieve your goals is just as important as stating them. Include a description of the goal, the time frame for achieving it, the amount of money needed, the amount already saved, and your plan for achieving the goal (for example, putting aside \$100 a month, working ten hours of overtime a week, cutting entertainment costs in half, or getting a second job). Having a deadline for achieving your goal creates a sense of urgency that makes it easier to stay focused.

When writing down your goals, do it in enough detail to give yourself a visual each time you read it. If you're saving to buy a house, don't just write down "buy our own house." Write so you can almost see it: "I want to buy a cozy cape-style home with a water view on two or more wooded acres on the coast of Maine." Each time you think of this goal, picture this cozy home in your mind. The more vividly you can imagine what your goal will look like, feel like, and smell like, the better chance you have of achieving it.